

RESERVED PARKING FOR PEOPLE WITH DISABILITIES

Parking reserved for persons with disabilities is a legal requirement. These special parking spaces for motorists with disabilities ensure safe and equal access to goods and services, access which is taken for granted by many persons. You can park in reserved spaces only if you have a permit or vehicle plates for persons with disabilities and only when the person who received the permit or vehicle plates is in the vehicle.



It is illegal for any vehicle to park, stop or stand in a space reserved for the disabled unless it has vehicle plates for the disabled issued by the DMV, a New York State Parking Permit for the Disabled issued by a city, town, county or village or a similar vehicle plate or permit issued by another state. The vehicle must be in operation to transport the disabled person described in the registration or permit. This law applies to spaces reserved and provided by local ordinance on streets and highways and those held for special use by state law in shopping centers that have five or more stores and 20 or more off-street public parking spaces.

It is a misdemeanor to make a false statement or give false information on an application for vehicle plates, and you would be subject to a mandatory license revocation and could face a fine, incarceration, or both, plus a mandatory surcharge. Additionally, if you make a false statement or provide false information to get a parking permit for a person with a disability, you face possible civil penalties from \$250 to \$1,000 and a mandatory surcharge. These penalties apply to the applicant and to a doctor who provides certification.

To apply for vehicle plates for the disabled or for a NYS Parking Permit for the Disabled use the MV-664.1 Instructions and Application for a Parking Permit or License Plates for People with Severe Disabilities.

Reserved spaces must be marked with signs

like the one shown above, and also can be designated with pavement markings. Do not park in the spaces with diagonal stripes next to reserved parking areas. These spaces are needed to give access to those with wheelchairs and vehicles with special equipment.

The fines for parking violations on a street are set by municipalities. Unless a municipality sets higher penalties, the fine for a shopping center violation is \$50 to \$75 for a first offense and \$75 to \$150 for a second offense within two years in the same municipality. A mandatory surcharge of \$30 will be added to each penalty.

QUESTIONS

Before you go on to Chapter 8, make sure you can answer these questions:

- After you have parallel parked, how near to the curb must your vehicle be?
- May you open a door on the road side of your vehicle if there is no oncoming traffic?
- Before you leave a parking space, what should you do?
- What does a NO STOPPING sign mean?
- Can you stop to load or drop off passengers at a NO STANDING or NO PARKING sign?
- May you park on a crosswalk in the middle of a block?